

SAMUEL MSAFARI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Mission-driven IT Operations & Service Delivery Manager with over 8 years of experience directing high-performance, globally distributed engineering teams. Proven track record of managing enterprise people, processes, and systems for multi-site organizations up to 3,500 users. Specializes in optimizing ITIL service desk workflows, driving automated Joiner-Mover-Leaver (JML) pipelines, and securing collaboration stacks across Okta, Google Workspace, and Microsoft 365. A Responsible Owner who translates structured KPI metrics into operational excellence, unblocking engineering teams while maintaining strict compliance (ITGC) and a 91% aggregate security baseline.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Migrated 1,000+ enterprise users to Microsoft 365, achieving a 91% Secure Score across all endpoints.
- Reduced service desk resolution times by 28% through process automation and team coaching programmes.
- Led cross-regional IT project teams of up to 15 engineers across four offices to deliver enterprise transformation programmes.
- Appointed as the primary technical advisor to executive leadership and the Board at a national parastatal, actively participating in C-suite strategic recruitment and enterprise-level operational decisions.

SKILLS

Leadership & Service Delivery

Team Leadership & Mentoring, Service Management Experience, IT Service Management (ITIL), SLA Management & Reporting, Service Delivery Optimization, Vendor & Supplier Management, Stakeholder Engagement, Change Management, Policy Development & Governance, Financial Planning, Project Management, Strategic Planning, Structured Reporting, Driving Operational Excellence

Cybersecurity & Compliance

Cybersecurity Operations, Identity & Access Management (IAM), Application Access Control, Endpoint Security & MDM, Threat Detection & Incident Response, Microsoft Sentinel & Defender, AI Agent Security, Data Governance & DLP, Risk Management & Compliance Auditing, Disaster Recovery & Business Continuity, GDPR | PCI-DSS | ISO 27001 Awareness

Cloud & Infrastructure

Microsoft 365 Administration, Microsoft Azure & Entra ID, Microsoft Intune, Microsoft Purview, SharePoint Online & Exchange, PowerShell Scripting & Automation, ServiceNow, SAP Integration, SQL Server, Power BI, Check Point Harmony, TLS/SSL | DNS | Network Protocols, End User Computing

EXPERIENCE

IT Operations Contract Specialist – Microsoft Business Assist | Upwork (Remote Contract) | Mar 2024 – Jul 2025

Professional contract engagement supporting Microsoft's Business Assist Operations division, managing global M365 support queue operations for enterprise clients.

- Streamlined global case triage workflows in collaboration with Business Assist Operations Leads, reducing average resolution times and improving SLA compliance across distributed support teams through corporate technology operational support.
- Optimised ticket assignment using workload analytics, boosting operational efficiency by 22% and raising client satisfaction scores to 91%, strengthening operational support metrics and driving operational excellence.
- Developed real-time KPI tracking dashboards for SLA adherence, enhancing executive visibility and enabling structured reporting for senior stakeholders.
- Coordinated cross-functional remote collaboration with leads and support ambassadors via Microsoft Teams and ServiceNow, managing 200+ active enterprise cases weekly across a global 18/7 shift rotation model actively operating across APAC, EST, and PST coverage windows.
- Delivered virtual training and mentoring for support ambassadors, reinforcing escalation procedures and helping drive adoption through targeted enablement and knowledge sharing.
- Standardised knowledge base documentation for recurring technical issues, reducing case reassignments and accelerating resolution.

ICT Officer | Geothermal Development Company | Nairobi, Kenya | Jul 2013 – May 2024

Served as the primary technical authority for all Microsoft-stack operations within a 30-person IT department, owning day-to-day IT operations, enterprise security, and major transformation programmes for 1,000+ users across four regional offices. Reported to the IT Manager while functioning as the trusted IT advisor to executive leadership and the Board.

- Led migration of 1,000+ enterprise users to Microsoft 365, planning and executing onboarding, training, and technical support, which improved collaboration efficiency and minimised downtime during the transition.
- Deployed Microsoft Sentinel and Defender to strengthen cybersecurity posture, reducing security incidents and achieving a 91% Secure Score across all endpoints.
- Conducted comprehensive security and compliance training for IT service desk teams, successfully optimizing IT General Controls (ITGC) for organizational audits while reducing triage times by 21%.
- Delivered Tier 2/3 technical support for critical escalations, resolving complex issues with 94% accuracy and ensuring uninterrupted business operations.
- Deployed Microsoft Intune to enforce endpoint security for 500+ devices, implementing conditional access, encryption, and compliance policies to support application access control.
- Collaborated remotely with vendors, Microsoft engineers, and cross-functional teams to troubleshoot complex issues and deploy system upgrades without impacting operations, demonstrating strong business relationships and supplier relationship experience.
- Automated Joiner, Mover, and Leaver (JML) workflows using PowerShell identity provisioning, syncing M365 and Entra ID permissions with downstream enterprise architectures (Okta/Google Workspace) to secure the user access lifecycle.

Team Leader - Managed Desktop Services | Barclays Bank of Kenya | Nairobi, Kenya | Apr 2010 – Jul 2013

Led a team of 5 engineers delivering desktop, server, and enterprise infrastructure support for 3,500 staff across 80+ branches, covering core banking systems, enterprise email, and collaboration platforms.

- Directed desktop and server support operations handling 100+ daily tickets across a 3,500-user, 80-branch estate, introducing proactive maintenance and workflow improvements that reduced backlog by 16% and increased system availability while strengthening end user computing support.
- Mentored and coached a team of 5 IT engineers, implementing continuous development programmes that improved technical competency and raised customer satisfaction by 21% year-over-year.
- Established structured escalation paths and detailed documentation, reducing average resolution times and improving SLA compliance across a geographically distributed environment.
- Oversaw Windows updates and enterprise system upgrades with 99.8% endpoint compliance, minimising business disruption across the branch network.
- Conducted ITIL-based service delivery audits and performance reviews, establishing best practices that strengthened team accountability and service quality, reflecting strong service management experience.
- Introduced preventive maintenance schedules that reduced user downtime by 18%, increasing productivity and reducing repeat incidents.

EARLIER CAREER

- **Systems Administrator — Managed Desktop Services** | Barclays Bank of Kenya, Nairobi
- **Technical Support Specialist** | Paetec Communications Inc., Rochester NY
- **Customer Service Lead** | Paetec Communications Inc., Rochester NY

KEY DELIVERABLES

Microsoft 365 Enterprise Migration | Geothermal Development Company

- Led a 15-person cross-regional team across four offices to migrate 1,000+ enterprise users from on-premises infrastructure to Microsoft 365, delivering full onboarding, training, and technical support with zero unplanned downtime. Achieved a 91% Secure Score through simultaneous deployment of Microsoft Sentinel and Defender, improving collaboration efficiency by 32%.

Employee Self-Service (ESS) Portal | Geothermal Development Company

- Co-project lead for the design and implementation of a SharePoint Online-based ESS portal integrated with on-premises SAP, digitising HR workflows for leave, allowances, and travel requests across 1,000+ employees — eliminating paper-based processes and advancing organisational digital transformation.

EDUCATION

- **B.Sc. Management Information Systems** | Rochester Institute of Technology | Expected: December 2026
- **International Baccalaureate Diploma** | St. Mary's School, Nairobi

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified AI Agent Security Specialist – Proofpoint | April 2026
- Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) – ISC2 | May 2024
- Security Operations Analyst Associate (SC-200) – Microsoft | Jun 2023
- Azure Administrator / Cloud Fundamentals – Microsoft | 2023 (*Azure Fundamentals May 2023, Azure Data Fundamentals Apr 2023*)
- Security, Compliance & Identity Fundamentals (SC-900) – Microsoft | Jan 2023
- ITIL Service Management Foundation – EXIN

TOOLS

Google Workspace, Microsoft 365, Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender, Microsoft Intune, Microsoft Entra, Microsoft Purview, Azure Portal, SharePoint, Exchange, OneDrive, Teams | ServiceNow, Jira, Power BI, PowerShell | Okta, Check Point Harmony Email & Collaboration, Splunk | SAP, SQL Server | GitHub, Slack, TLS/SSL, DNS

LANGUAGES

❖ English - Fluent

❖ Swahili - Native

REFEREES

AVAILABLE UPON REQUEST